ASTERION DIGITAL SYSTEMS PRIVATE LIMITED

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

& Corporate HR Policy Manual

A practical guide to our workplace, people practices, compensation, conduct and career development

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2. Important Notice, Scope & Document Governance

Welcome to Asterion Digital Systems. This handbook explains the employment standards and internal processes used at our company. It is designed to provide employees with a consistent reference point.

2.1 Purpose of the handbook

The handbook describes workplace expectations, employee support, compensation administration, working arrangements, information security, performance management and separation procedures. It is intended to help employees understand how the organization operates and where to seek guidance.

2.2 Who must follow it

- All regular full-time and part-time employees, unless a section expressly states otherwise.
- Interns, apprentices, trainees and fixed-term employees must follow conduct, security, attendance and workplace safety requirements. Their compensation and leave entitlements are governed by their individual agreements and applicable law.
- Consultants, vendors and visitors must comply with relevant site, confidentiality and security requirements while on company premises or systems.

2.3 Relationship with employment agreements and law

This handbook is a policy guide and does not replace an appointment letter, employment agreement, statutory notice, benefit plan document or applicable Indian law. Where a contractual term or policy conflicts with mandatory law, the law prevails. Where an individual agreement provides a more favourable lawful entitlement, that agreement will be reviewed by HR.

2.4 Interpretation and policy ownership

The People & Culture Department administers this handbook in consultation with Finance, Legal, Information Security and business leaders. Managers may explain procedures but may not create exceptions to statutory requirements. Any exception to an internal policy must be documented and approved by the authorized function.

2.5 Changes and employee acknowledgement

The company may revise policies to reflect operational needs, legal changes or improvements in employee experience. Material updates will be communicated through official email or the HR portal. Employees are expected to read updated policies and complete acknowledgement tasks within the stated period.

3. About Asterion Digital Systems

Asterion Digital Systems Private Limited is an India-based technology and digital engineering services company established in 2017. The organization builds and operates software products and technology solutions for businesses.

3.1 Company profile

Asterion Digital Systems works across product engineering, enterprise application development, cloud modernization, data platforms, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and managed technology services. Its client portfolio includes early-stage companies, mid-sized Indian businesses and selected international enterprises.

3.2 Mission

To make useful technology dependable, secure and accessible by combining thoughtful engineering, responsible innovation and long-term customer partnerships.

3.3 Vision

To become a trusted digital engineering partner recognized for quality delivery, technical depth, ethical conduct and an environment where people can build meaningful careers.

3.4 Core values

- Customer outcomes: understand the problem before proposing a solution; measure success by the value delivered.
- Ownership: take responsibility for commitments, communicate risks early and close the loop.
- Craftsmanship: write maintainable software, test carefully and document important decisions.
- Integrity: be honest about progress, capability, estimates, errors and conflicts of interest.
- Respect: treat colleagues, clients and partners fairly regardless of role or background.
- Learning: share knowledge, seek feedback and improve systems rather than repeating avoidable mistakes.

3.5 Operating principles

Teams are expected to work transparently, use evidence when making decisions, keep customer data secure and avoid unnecessary bureaucracy. Asterion Digital Systems favours small accountable teams, written project decisions and clear escalation paths. Speed is valued, but not at the cost of safety, legality or engineering quality.

4. Services, Expertise & Industry Focus

Asterion Digital Systems's service portfolio is organized around engineering capabilities rather than a single technology stack. Teams may be assigned to internal products, client delivery, research initiatives or long-term support engagements.

4.1 Core service lines

Service line	Typical work
Product & application engineering	Web and mobile applications, APIs, platform architecture, testing and maintenance
Cloud & DevOps	Cloud migration, infrastructure automation, CI/CD, observability and reliability engineering
AI, data & automation	Data pipelines, analytics, machine learning prototypes, retrieval-augmented generation and workflow automation
Cybersecurity	Secure development reviews, identity controls, vulnerability management and security assessments
Enterprise integration	ERP/CRM integrations, workflow systems, API gateways and legacy modernization
Technology consulting	Discovery workshops, architecture reviews, delivery planning and technical due diligence

4.2 Technology expertise

- Frontend: React, Next.js, TypeScript, HTML, CSS and accessible UI engineering.
- Backend: Java, Node.js, Python, REST APIs, event-driven systems and service integration.
- Data: SQL databases, document databases, data modeling, reporting and pipeline orchestration.
- Cloud and platform: containerization, CI/CD, infrastructure as code, monitoring and cloud security fundamentals.
- AI engineering: model integration, evaluation, prompt design, retrieval systems, agent workflows and human review controls.
- Quality engineering: test automation, API testing, performance testing, release validation and defect analysis.

4.3 Industry exposure

Sectors served include financial services, retail and commerce, education technology, healthcare technology, logistics, manufacturing and SaaS. Work in regulated or sensitive sectors may require additional background checks, training, access restrictions and client-specific controls.

4.4 Skills are not guarantees

The presence of a technology in this section does not mean every employee or team uses it. Project allocation depends on business demand, demonstrated capability, training, client requirements and security approvals.

5. Company Structure, Offices & Governance

The company uses a functional structure with delivery teams organized around customer programmes, internal platforms and specialist practices. Reporting lines are communicated through appointment documentation and the HR portal.

5.1 Office footprint

Office	Primary function	Headcount
Bengaluru, Karnataka	Head office, engineering, leadership and shared services	260
Hyderabad, Telangana	Cloud, data and enterprise delivery	110
Pune, Maharashtra	Product engineering and quality assurance	75
Noida, Uttar Pradesh	Client delivery, support and business operations	55
Total		500

5.2 Leadership and governance

- Board of Directors: strategic oversight, governance and major corporate decisions.
- Chief Executive Officer (Aarav Sharma): company strategy, culture, financial sustainability and business performance.
- Chief Operating Officer (Karan Malhotra): delivery operations, resource planning and service quality.
- Chief Technology Officer (Priya Verma): technical direction, architecture standards and engineering excellence.
- Chief Financial Officer (Meera Iyer): budgeting, payroll controls, accounting and financial reporting.
- Head of People & Culture (Deepa Nair): recruitment, employee relations, HR operations and policy administration.
- Chief Information Security Officer (Sandeep Joshi): security governance, risk management and incident response.

5.3 Department structure

Typical departments include Engineering, Product, AI & Data, Cloud & Infrastructure, Cybersecurity, Quality Engineering, Customer Success, Sales & Partnerships, Finance, Legal & Compliance, People & Culture and Corporate Administration.

5.4 Decision rights

Employees should first raise routine work questions with their reporting manager. Policy interpretation belongs to HR; salary processing belongs to Payroll/Finance; system access and security incidents belong to IT/Security; client commitments and scope changes require the designated delivery or account owner.

6. Work Culture & Employee Experience

Asterion Digital Systems aims to maintain a professional, collaborative and delivery-focused culture. Culture is reflected in everyday decisions: how teams communicate, resolve disagreements, share credit, respond to mistakes and protect one another's ability to do good work.

6.1 Expected behaviours

- Be clear and respectful in meetings, written messages and code reviews.
- Share progress and blockers early; do not hide delays until a deadline has passed.
- Disagree with ideas using evidence, not personal attacks or status.
- Give credit to contributors and document reusable knowledge.
- Respect focus time, time zones, leave and reasonable boundaries outside working hours.
- Raise safety, ethical, security or quality concerns without fear of retaliation.

6.2 Collaboration practices

Teams may use daily or periodic stand-ups, sprint planning, design reviews, retrospectives, one-to-one meetings and written status updates. Meetings should have a purpose, an owner and an expected outcome. Decisions affecting scope, architecture, security or delivery dates should be recorded in an approved workspace.

6.3 Feedback and psychological safety

Managers should provide specific, timely and actionable feedback. Employees may ask for clarification, request a private discussion or use the grievance process where feedback becomes humiliating, discriminatory or retaliatory. Psychological safety does not remove accountability; it enables people to report risks and learn from mistakes.

6.4 Inclusion and accessibility

The company prohibits discrimination and harassment on grounds protected by applicable law. Reasonable workplace adjustments may be discussed confidentially with HR. Team events and internal communications should be planned with accessibility, dietary needs and varied personal circumstances in mind.

6.5 Recognition

Recognition may include peer appreciation, project acknowledgements, learning opportunities, internal awards or performance-linked rewards. Recognition is not a substitute for fair pay, safe working conditions or consistent management.

7. Working Hours, Shifts & Attendance

Standard office schedules are designed to support collaboration across teams while allowing predictable personal time. Client or operational roles may follow approved shift arrangements communicated in writing.

7.1 Standard schedule

Item	Standard arrangement
Working days	Monday to Friday
Core office hours	9:30 AM to 6:30 PM
Meal break	1:00 PM to 2:00 PM
Short breaks	Two reasonable 15-minute breaks
Weekly rest days	Saturday and Sunday
Expected work time	Approximately 40 hours per week, excluding meal break

7.2 Flexible start time

With manager approval, eligible employees may start between 8:00 AM and 11:00 AM and complete the required daily working hours. Employees must still attend mandatory customer meetings, team ceremonies and agreed collaboration windows. Flexibility is a working arrangement, not an entitlement to be unavailable during agreed core hours.

7.3 Attendance recording

- Record attendance through the approved HR portal, access system or designated timekeeping application.
- Remote employees must use the approved attendance workflow and accurately record working time.
- Submit an attendance correction request within 48 hours of discovering an error.
- Repeated unexplained absence, proxy attendance or falsified records may lead to investigation and disciplinary action.

7.4 Late arrival and absence

The standard arrival grace period is until 9:45 AM. More than five late arrivals in a calendar month may trigger a manager discussion and, where appropriate, a formal warning. Employees unable to attend must inform their manager as early as reasonably possible and follow the leave procedure.

7.5 Shift work and overtime

Certain support, infrastructure and client operations teams may work staggered or rotational shifts. Shift timings, weekly rest and applicable allowances must be documented before the arrangement begins. Overtime must be approved in advance and handled in accordance with applicable law, contract terms and company rules. Employees should not assume that unapproved extra hours automatically qualify for additional payment.

8. Hybrid Work & Remote Work Policy

Asterion Digital Systems follows a hybrid model for eligible roles. The arrangement is based on job requirements, customer commitments, information security and team effectiveness; it is not identical across all departments.

8.1 Eligibility and frequency

Employees who have completed three months of service may request up to two remote working days per week, subject to manager approval and role suitability. New joiners, employees in structured training, employees handling restricted environments and roles requiring physical equipment access may be required to work onsite.

8.2 Request and approval

- Submit the proposed remote day through the HR portal at least one working day in advance where practicable.
- The manager confirms coverage, meetings, deliverables and any customer restrictions.
- A recurring arrangement must be reviewed periodically and may be modified for operational reasons.
- International remote work requires written approval from HR, the department head and any relevant security or legal function.

8.3 Remote work standards

- Maintain a stable and secure internet connection and a private work area.
- Use company-approved devices, VPN and collaboration tools where required.
- Remain reachable during agreed working hours and attend scheduled meetings.
- Protect screens and conversations from household members or public visibility.
- Do not print, download or locally store restricted information without authorization.
- Update task status and hand over urgent work before signing off.

8.4 Equipment and expenses

Company-issued equipment remains company property and must be used responsibly. Eligible remote employees may claim internet reimbursement up to ₹1,000 per month against required proof and within the expense deadline. Furniture, electricity and other home-office expenses are not reimbursable unless approved in writing.

8.5 Review and withdrawal

Managers may review remote arrangements based on delivery, customer feedback, security events, attendance and team needs. A remote arrangement may be temporarily suspended where a role changes, a client requires onsite presence or policy requirements are not met.

9. Compensation Philosophy & Salary Structure

Compensation is determined by role scope, capability, relevant experience, location, internal parity, market conditions and business affordability. The bands below are for guidance and do not constitute a promise of employment; individual compensation is as stated in the offer letter.

9.1 Compensation principles

Asterion Digital Systems aims to offer clear, explainable compensation with a documented fixed-pay component and, where applicable, variable pay. Salary decisions should be consistent across comparable roles and reviewed for unjustified disparities. Offers are approved through the authorized hiring and finance process.

9.2 Annual CTC bands

Job level	Example roles	Annual CTC
L1 — Graduate / Associate	Graduate Engineer, Junior Analyst	₹3.6–6.0 LPA
L2 — Engineer	Software Engineer, QA Engineer	₹6.0–10.0 LPA
L3 — Senior Engineer	Senior Developer, Data Engineer	₹10.0–16.0 LPA
L4 — Lead / Specialist	Tech Lead, Security Specialist	₹16.0–24.0 LPA
L5 — Manager	Engineering Manager, Delivery Manager	₹22.0–32.0 LPA
L6 — Senior Leadership	Director, Practice Head	₹30.0–50.0+ LPA

9.3 CTC components

Component	Typical treatment
Basic salary	Fixed monthly component; basis for certain statutory calculations
House Rent Allowance	May be provided according to salary design and applicable tax rules
Special/flexible allowance	Balancing fixed-pay component as stated in the offer
Employer PF contribution	Included in CTC where applicable
Gratuity provision	Included in CTC where applicable and as calculated under law
Variable pay	Only where expressly stated; subject to eligibility and plan rules
Insurance / benefits	Employer-paid benefits may be reflected in total rewards communication

> CTC is not the same as take-home pay. Actual net salary depends on salary components, employee PF, professional tax, income-tax withholding, insurance deductions and other lawful deductions.

10. Payroll, Bonus, Incentives & Reimbursements

Payroll is administered monthly using approved employee records and bank details. Employees should review their payslips and raise discrepancies promptly so that corrections can be assessed within payroll timelines.

10.1 Payroll cycle

Payroll item	Policy approach
Payroll period	First to last calendar day of each month
Salary payment	Normally on the last working day of the month
Payment method	Direct transfer to verified employee bank account
Payslip	Published in the secure employee portal
Bank holiday	Payment is normally processed on the preceding working day

10.2 Variable pay and performance bonus

Where an offer letter includes variable compensation, the applicable plan will state the target amount, measurement period, performance conditions, payment timing and treatment during leave or separation. A target incentive may range from 0% to 15% of annual fixed pay for eligible roles; actual plans vary by role and are not guaranteed unless contractually stated.

10.3 Spot awards and referral awards

The company may operate discretionary recognition awards for exceptional delivery, innovation, customer impact or employee referrals. Eligibility, payout value and tax treatment are governed by the active scheme. Referral awards are payable only after the referred candidate joins and completes the scheme's stated retention period.

10.4 Expense reimbursement

- Obtain prior approval for travel, client entertainment, equipment or training expenses where required.
- Submit itemized receipts and business purpose through the expense portal within 30 days.
- Personal purchases, alcohol where prohibited by policy, fines, upgrades without approval and unsupported claims are not reimbursable.
- Managers must verify business purpose; Finance may reject incomplete, duplicate or non-compliant claims.

10.5 Salary queries and corrections

Employees should raise payroll queries through the HR portal within 10 working days of receiving the payslip. Payroll will acknowledge the query and investigate source records. Confirmed underpayments or overpayments will be corrected through the next feasible payroll cycle or another documented method.

11. Benefits, Insurance & Employee Support

Benefits are designed to support employee well-being and retention. Eligibility depends on employment category, insurer terms, plan documents and applicable law. The official benefit communication and policy schedule prevail over this summary.

11.1 Benefits for eligible full-time employees

Benefit	Provision
Group medical insurance	Coverage up to ₹5,00,000, subject to insurer terms
Personal accident cover	Coverage as defined in the annual group policy
Provident Fund	As applicable under law and eligibility rules
Gratuity	As applicable under law
Learning allowance	Up to ₹12,000 per financial year, pre-approved
Internet reimbursement	Up to ₹1,000 per month for eligible remote employees
Annual health / wellness initiatives	Company-organized sessions or optional programmes

11.2 Medical insurance

HR will share the insurer, policy number, coverage limits, dependent rules, exclusions, cashless network and claim process separately. Employees must provide accurate enrollment information and notify HR of eligible changes within the insurer's required timelines. Coverage is subject to policy wording and insurer decisions.

11.3 Retirement and statutory benefits

Provident Fund, gratuity and other statutory benefits will be administered according to applicable eligibility and legal requirements. Employees may contact Payroll for contribution statements and HR for general process guidance. The company does not provide tax or investment advice.

11.4 Learning and wellness

The annual learning allowance may be used for approved technical courses, recognized certifications, books or professional learning platforms. Unused amounts expire at financial year-end and cannot be encashed or transferred. Reimbursement above ₹15,000 for a single programme requires department-head approval.

11.5 Interns and fixed-term employees

Interns and fixed-term employees receive only the benefits expressly stated in their agreement or required by law. They are not automatically eligible for the full-time employee insurance, earned leave or learning allowance programmes.

12. Leave, Time Off & Holiday Calendar

Leave is intended to support rest, health, family responsibilities and personal commitments. Employees must apply through the HR portal and obtain approval before treating planned leave as confirmed.

12.1 Annual leave entitlement — full-time schedule

Leave category	Annual entitlement	Key conditions
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days	Short personal needs; normally max 2 consecutive days
Sick Leave (SL)	8 days	Medical reasons; documentation may be requested
Earned Leave (EL)	15 days	Planned leave; request 7 calendar days in advance
Optional Holidays	2 days	Choose from approved list
Paternity Leave	10 working days	Normally within 90 days of birth or adoption
Maternity Leave	As applicable under law	Subject to statutory eligibility and process

12.2 Carry-forward and encashment

A maximum of 30 earned leave days may be carried forward, subject to applicable law and the company's leave system. Casual and sick leave generally expire at year-end and are not encashable under this policy. Earned leave settlement at separation is handled according to applicable law and the governing policy.

12.3 Leave application

- Casual leave should normally be requested one working day in advance.
- Earned leave should normally be requested at least seven calendar days in advance.
- Sick leave should be reported to the manager as early as possible, preferably before 10:00 AM on the first day.
- Medical documentation may be required for more than two consecutive working days of sick leave.
- Leave exceeding 10 consecutive working days, leave without pay and extended medical leave require HR review.

12.4 x

Date	Holiday	Category
26 January 2027	Republic Day	National
6 March 2027	Holi	Company
26 March 2027	Good Friday	Company
15 August 2027	Independence Day	National
2 October 2027	Gandhi Jayanti	National

Date	Holiday	Category
9 October 2027	Dussehra	Company
29 October 2027	Diwali	Company
25 December 2027	Christmas	Company

Regional holidays may differ by office and local statutory requirements. HR will publish the final calendar after review; dates must be checked against the relevant state calendar.

13. Recruitment, Selection & Employment Checks

Recruitment decisions should be based on role requirements, demonstrated skills, relevant experience and fair assessment. Hiring managers and recruiters must communicate accurately and protect candidate information.

13.1 Recruitment stages

- Role approval and job description: business need, level, reporting line and budget are confirmed.
- Application screening: qualifications and relevant experience are reviewed against the role criteria.
- Assessment: technical, functional, writing or case-based exercises may be used where relevant.
- Interview: structured discussion with role-related questions and consistent evaluation criteria.
- Reference or background checks: performed only where appropriate, lawful and disclosed.
- Offer and acceptance: written terms, compensation, joining date and conditions are shared by authorized HR.

13.2 Fair selection

Candidates must not be asked for payment, deposits or purchases as a condition of recruitment. Interviewers must avoid discriminatory questions unrelated to legitimate job requirements. Assessment tasks should be proportionate and should not be used to obtain unpaid production work.

13.3 Verification

Subject to applicable law and candidate consent where required, the company may verify identity, education, employment history, professional credentials and references. Any discrepancy should be reviewed fairly, with an opportunity for the candidate to clarify material information.

13.4 Offer and joining documents

The offer letter will identify job title, work location, reporting manager, compensation, employment category, probation terms, notice period and any role-specific conditions. Employees must submit accurate joining documents through the approved secure channel.

13.5 Internal mobility

Employees may apply for internal openings where they meet role requirements and have completed any stated minimum tenure. Transfers require approval from the current and receiving managers and HR. Internal applications must not result in retaliation or unfair treatment.

14. Onboarding, Probation & Confirmation

Onboarding helps new employees understand the company, their role, team expectations and essential controls. Managers are responsible for providing a realistic first-month plan and access to the tools required for the role.

14.1 First 10 working days

Period	Core activities
Day 1	Welcome, identity verification, policies, equipment and access setup
Days 2–3	Company overview, team introductions, security and conduct training
Days 4–5	Role objectives, tools, architecture or process walkthrough
Week 2	Starter tasks, mentor check-in, expectations and learning plan

14.2 Probation

The standard probation period is six months unless the offer letter states otherwise. During probation, the manager should review role fit, quality, reliability, communication, learning progress and conduct. Probation may be confirmed, extended with written reasons or ended in accordance with the employment agreement and applicable law.

14.3 Confirmation

Confirmation is communicated in writing by HR after the manager's recommendation and required approvals. Employees should not assume that probation has ended merely because the stated period has elapsed. Any extension should identify the development areas, review date and support available.

14.4 Manager responsibilities

- Set clear 30-, 60- and 90-day outcomes.
- Assign a buddy or mentor where feasible.
- Ensure access is role-appropriate and removed when no longer needed.
- Schedule regular check-ins and provide actionable feedback.
- Explain escalation routes, leave procedures and performance expectations.

14.5 Employee responsibilities

New employees must complete mandatory training, follow security requirements, ask questions when instructions are unclear and promptly report missing access, equipment or support. Employees must not share passwords or use another person's account to bypass access controls.

15. Internships, Trainees & Graduate Programme

Asterion Digital Systems's early-career programme provides structured exposure to real engineering practices. An internship is a learning and assessment arrangement, not a promise of permanent employment.

15.1 Programme design

Standard internships are planned for three months in software engineering, AI and data, cloud operations, cybersecurity, quality engineering, business analysis or product operations. Each intern receives a written scope, a designated mentor and measurable deliverables.

15.2 Internship terms

Item	Arrangement
Duration	3 months
Monthly stipend	₹10,000, subject to signed agreement
Working days	Monday to Friday
Weekly holidays	Saturday and Sunday
Leave	2 casual leave days per month, subject to agreement
Mentorship	Named reporting mentor
Feedback	Monthly progress discussion
Completion evidence	Certificate after successful completion and deliverable submission

15.3 Intern responsibilities

- Attend agreed sessions and communicate absence promptly.
- Complete assigned learning and project deliverables honestly.
- Use only approved systems and protect company/client information.
- Do not publish project code, screenshots or customer details without written approval.
- Ask for review when blocked and document work so it can be assessed.

15.4 Evaluation

Monthly reviews may assess technical progress, task quality, initiative, communication, reliability, collaboration and ability to respond to feedback. The mentor should provide specific improvement points and a fair opportunity to address gaps.

15.5 Conversion and extension

High-performing interns may be considered for a graduate role where an approved vacancy exists. Conversion is not automatic and depends on business need, interview performance, budget and formal offer approval. Extensions require written approval from the department manager and HR.

> No recruitment or internship fee is payable to Asterion Digital Systems at any stage of this programme.

16. Performance Management, Ratings & Rankings

Performance management is intended to align individual contribution with business outcomes, support development and identify barriers to effective work. Ratings should be evidence-based and calibrated across comparable roles.

16.1 Review cycle

Formal reviews are conducted twice annually: January–June and July–December. Managers should hold regular check-ins throughout the year rather than relying only on review meetings. Employees may submit a self-assessment with examples, outcomes and development goals.

16.2 Evaluation dimensions

Dimension	What is assessed
Delivery & ownership	Commitment reliability, prioritization, follow-through and outcomes
Quality	Correctness, maintainability, testing, documentation and risk awareness
Technical / functional skill	Role knowledge, problem-solving and sound judgment
Collaboration	Communication, teamwork, review quality and knowledge sharing
Customer impact	Responsiveness, service quality and measurable user/client value
Professional conduct	Integrity, security, attendance and respectful behaviour

16.3 Rating scale

Rating	Label	Meaning
5	Exceptional	Consistently exceeds role expectations with substantial impact
4	Exceeds expectations	Frequently delivers beyond agreed expectations
3	Meets expectations	Reliably fulfils the requirements of the role
2	Partially meets	Some expectations are missed; improvement plan is needed
1	Does not meet	Material and sustained gaps require urgent action

16.4 Internal contribution bands

For talent discussions only, the company may group performance outcomes into contribution bands: Exceptional (top impact), Strong (above role expectations), Solid (meets expectations) and Improvement Required. These are not public employee rankings, do not create guaranteed quotas and must not replace an individual's documented evidence.

16.5 Fairness and review challenge

Managers must avoid ranking employees solely by hours online, number of messages, personality similarity or visibility. Employees may request clarification of evidence and submit a written response to HR within 10 working days of receiving the formal review.

17. Promotion, Career Paths & Development

Career growth may occur through deeper technical specialization, broader leadership responsibility, product ownership or movement into another suitable function. Promotion is based on sustained readiness and available organizational need, not tenure alone.

17.1 Career levels

Level	Typical scope	Example next step
L1 Associate	Works with guidance; builds foundational skills	L2 Engineer
L2 Engineer	Owns defined tasks and components	L3 Senior Engineer
L3 Senior Engineer	Owns features or workstreams; mentors peers	L4 Lead / Specialist
L4 Lead / Specialist	Sets technical direction for a team or domain	L5 Manager / Principal
L5 Manager	Leads people, delivery or a major function	L6 Director
L6 Director	Owns multi-team strategy and outcomes	Executive leadership

17.2 Promotion readiness

- Consistent performance at the next-level scope, not isolated exceptional work.
- Demonstrated judgment, accountability and ability to handle greater complexity.
- Evidence of collaboration, mentoring or leadership appropriate to the target role.
- A sustained business need and an approved position or role redesign.
- Completion of any required technical, compliance or leadership assessment.

17.3 Development plans

Employees and managers should agree on one to three meaningful development priorities per review cycle. Plans may include project assignments, mentoring, technical learning, communication practice, certification or cross-functional exposure. Progress should be reviewed during regular one-to-one meetings.

17.4 Lateral movement

A lateral move may be appropriate where an employee's strengths align with another team or where the business needs a different skill mix. Transfers should include a transition plan, revised objectives and any necessary training.

17.5 No automatic entitlement

Completing a specific number of years, courses or certifications does not guarantee promotion or a salary increase. Decisions must be documented and communicated respectfully.

18. Learning, Certifications & Knowledge Sharing

Continuous learning is important in technology because tools, platforms, security threats and customer expectations change. Learning should be connected to role needs and applied through practical work.

18.1 Learning support

Eligible full-time employees may access an annual learning allowance of up to ₹12,000 for approved courses, professional certifications, books and technical resources. The allowance is subject to budget, approval and proof of completion. It cannot be encashed or carried forward.

18.2 Approval process

- Discuss the learning objective and expected work benefit with the manager.
- Submit course details, cost, provider and schedule through the learning request workflow.
- Obtain approval before purchase or enrollment.
- Complete the programme and submit certificate or other evidence.
- Submit eligible reimbursement documents within the stated expense period.

18.3 Higher-cost training

A single training request above ₹15,000 requires department-head approval. The company may require a service commitment or repayment arrangement only where lawful, proportionate and documented in a separate agreement before the training begins.

18.4 Internal knowledge sharing

Teams are encouraged to conduct technical talks, design walkthroughs, incident reviews, code-reading sessions and onboarding demonstrations. Shared materials must not contain client secrets, personal data or licensed content used outside its permitted terms.

18.5 Certifications

Certification support depends on role relevance, provider credibility, budget and business need. Employees must not misrepresent a course attendance badge as a professional certification or claim credentials that have expired or been revoked.

19. Code of Conduct, Ethics & Conflicts of Interest

Employees are expected to act honestly, lawfully and professionally. The code applies to company premises, remote work, customer sites, work-related events and use of company systems.

19.1 Prohibited conduct

- Harassment, discrimination, bullying, threats or retaliation.
- Falsifying attendance, expenses, qualifications, project records or performance data.
- Unauthorized disclosure of company, employee or client information.
- Misuse, theft or intentional damage of company property or systems.
- Bribery, kickbacks, improper gifts or undisclosed vendor benefits.
- Use of company systems for unlawful activity or unauthorized commercial activity.
- Misrepresenting work completed, source code ownership or professional experience.

19.2 Conflicts of interest

Employees must disclose personal, financial or family interests that could influence business decisions. Examples include selecting a relative's business as a vendor, holding a material interest in a competitor, using confidential information for personal gain or supervising a close relative without safeguards.

19.3 Gifts and hospitality

Employees must not request or accept cash, loans, personal discounts or benefits in exchange for business decisions. Modest customary gifts may be accepted only where lawful, transparent and permitted by the active gifts policy. Anything that could create an obligation or appear to influence judgment must be declined and reported.

19.4 Outside work and intellectual property

Employees must obtain written approval before taking outside employment, consulting or commercial work that may conflict with company duties, use company resources or affect performance. Inventions and work product created within the scope of employment are governed by the employment agreement and applicable law.

19.5 Consequences

Policy violations may result in coaching, written warning, access restriction, suspension or termination, depending on severity, evidence, prior history and applicable law. The employee will be given a fair opportunity to respond in accordance with the relevant process.

20. Information Security, Privacy & Acceptable Use

Every employee is responsible for protecting company systems, client information and personal data. Security requirements apply whether work is performed from an office, home or customer location.

20.1 Account and password security

- Use unique passwords of at least 12 characters where supported and enable multi-factor authentication.
- Never share passwords, one-time codes, recovery codes or access tokens.
- Use approved password managers and company identity systems.
- Report suspected phishing, credential theft or unauthorized access immediately.

20.2 Device and network security

- Use approved devices for restricted business information.
- Keep operating systems, endpoint protection and applications updated.
- Lock screens when away and protect devices during travel.
- Do not connect unknown removable media or bypass security controls.
- Report a lost or stolen company device to IT/Security within one hour of discovery.

20.3 Data classification and sharing

Information may be classified as Public, Internal, Confidential or Restricted. Employees must follow the handling rules for each class. Confidential or Restricted files must not be sent to personal email, unapproved cloud drives, public AI tools or unauthorized recipients.

20.4 Personal data

Employee information may be processed for recruitment, payroll, benefits, attendance, security, legal compliance and business operations. Access is limited to authorized personnel with a legitimate business need. Employees may request access or correction through HR or the designated privacy channel.

20.5 Retention and incident reporting

Records are retained according to the applicable retention schedule, contractual obligations and law. Suspected data loss, malware, privacy breach or unauthorized disclosure must be reported immediately through the security incident channel. Employees must preserve evidence and must not conduct their own unauthorized investigation.

> Never upload client code, confidential documents, credentials or personal data into an external AI service unless the service and use case have been explicitly approved.

21. Workplace Safety, POSH & Grievance Handling

Asterion Digital Systems is committed to a workplace free from sexual harassment, discrimination, intimidation and retaliation. Safety concerns and complaints must be handled promptly, fairly and with appropriate confidentiality.

21.1 Prevention of harassment

Harassment includes unwelcome conduct that violates applicable law or company policy, including sexual harassment, bullying, intimidation, discriminatory remarks and repeated hostile behaviour. The company prohibits retaliation against anyone who raises a genuine concern or participates in an inquiry.

21.2 POSH framework

Complaints covered by the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 must be handled through the legally required Internal Committee and statutory procedure. The company will communicate the Internal Committee's composition and contact details through official channels. This handbook does not replace statutory notices or the prescribed complaint process.

21.3 Reporting channels

- Reporting manager, unless the manager is involved or the employee is uncomfortable reporting to them.
- People & Culture / HR representative.
- Designated Internal Committee for complaints covered by POSH legislation.
- Confidential grievance channel: grievance@asteriondigital.test.
- Emergency services or appropriate authorities where there is an immediate safety risk.

21.4 Grievance process

Ordinary grievances should be acknowledged within three working days, with an initial response targeted within 10 working days. Complex matters may require additional time; HR should communicate the expected next step. Complaints will be handled discreetly to the extent reasonably possible, while ensuring a fair inquiry.

21.5 Workplace safety

Employees must follow building safety instructions, evacuation procedures, ergonomic guidance and incident reporting requirements. Injuries, hazards, unsafe equipment or threats must be reported promptly to Facilities or HR. No employee should interfere with emergency equipment or block exits.

22. Separation, Resignation & Exit Formalities

Employment may end through resignation, retirement, completion of a fixed term, mutual separation or termination in accordance with the employment agreement and applicable law. The process should protect dignity, business continuity and lawful employee entitlements.

22.1 Resignation and notice periods

Employee category	Notice period
Junior employees	30 days
Mid-level employees	45 days
Senior employees	60 days
Department heads	90 days
Interns	7 days, subject to agreement

The notice period and its commencement are governed by the appointment letter and applicable law. Notice reduction, waiver or buyout requires written approval and must be handled consistently with the contract.

22.2 Handover requirements

- Prepare a current status summary of projects, risks, dependencies and deadlines.
- Transfer approved documentation, repositories and operational knowledge.
- Return laptop, access card, peripherals and other company property.
- Submit outstanding expense claims and resolve advances where applicable.
- Complete required security, finance and departmental clearances.

22.3 Final settlement

Final wages, leave settlement, statutory dues, deductions and other amounts will be processed within applicable statutory and contractual timelines. Employees should provide updated bank and tax details and raise any settlement query through HR or Payroll.

22.4 Experience and relieving documents

Experience letters and relieving letters are issued after the required exit formalities and verification of employment records. The company will not withhold statutory dues in a manner contrary to applicable law.

22.5 Continuing obligations

Confidentiality, intellectual property, data protection and other obligations that lawfully survive employment continue after separation. Former employees must not retain company data or use credentials after access is revoked.

23. Policy Contacts, Acknowledgement & Final Provisions

This final section explains where employees should seek assistance and records the acknowledgement expected from each handbook recipient.

23.1 Functional contacts

Function	Owner	Email
People & Culture	Deepa Nair, Head of People & Culture	people@asteriondigital.test
Payroll & Finance	Pooja Menon, Payroll Executive	payroll@asteriondigital.test
IT Service Desk	Suresh Pillai, IT Support Lead	ithelp@asteriondigital.test
Information Security	Sandeep Joshi, CISO	security@asteriondigital.test
Privacy enquiries	Sandeep Joshi, CISO	privacy@asteriondigital.test
Grievance channel	Tanvi Deshpande, Employee Relations Officer	grievance@asteriondigital.test
Office administration	Facilities team	facilities@asteriondigital.test

23.2 Policy interpretation and escalation

Employees should use the relevant functional channel for policy questions. If a concern is unresolved, it may be escalated to the Head of People & Culture or the appropriate senior function. Matters involving immediate danger, suspected criminal conduct or statutory complaints should be directed to the appropriate authority or statutory mechanism.

23.3 Handbook acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received or been given access to the Asterion Digital Systems Employee Handbook. I understand that I am responsible for reading the policies relevant to my role, seeking clarification where necessary and complying with applicable company requirements. I understand that this handbook is a policy guide and does not override my employment agreement or applicable law.

Employee name _____

Employee ID _____

Department / location _____

Signature _____

Date _____

23.4 Document control

Item	Detail
Document owner	Head of People & Culture
Approved by	Karan Malhotra, Chief Operating Officer
Document ID / version	ADS-HR-001 / Version 1.0
Effective date	1 January 2027
Next review	1 January 2028
Status	Approved

24. Employee Directory

This directory lists key employees, their departments, reporting managers and joining dates. Employees should use the official email address for work communication. Reporting managers are shown by employee ID.

> Names, IDs and email addresses in this directory are test data (reserved @asteriondigital.test domain) and must be replaced with verified employee records before the handbook is circulated.

Employee ID	Full name	Designation	Department	Reports to	Location	Date of joining	Email
ADS001	Aarav Sharma	Chief Executive Officer	Leadership	Board of Directors	Bengaluru	01 Mar 2017	aarav.sharma@asteriondigital.test
ADS002	Priya Verma	Chief Technology Officer	Technology	ADS001	Bengaluru	10 Apr 2017	priya.verma@asteriondigital.test
ADS003	Rahul Mehta	HR Manager	Human Resources	ADS009	Bengaluru	17 Jun 2019	rahul.mehta@asteriondigital.test
ADS004	Sneha Kapoor	Engineering Manager	Engineering	ADS002	Bengaluru	03 Sep 2018	sneha.kapoor@asteriondigital.test
ADS005	Arjun Patel	Senior Software Engineer	Engineering	ADS004	Bengaluru	13 Jan 2020	arjun.patel@asteriondigital.test
ADS006	Neha Singh	Software Engineer	Engineering	ADS004	Pune	04 Jul 2022	neha.singh@asteriondigital.test
ADS007	Vikram Reddy	QA Engineer	Quality Assurance	ADS012	Hyderabad	20 Feb 2023	vikram.reddy@asteriondigital.test
ADS008	Ananya Gupta	Data Analyst Intern	Data & Analytics	ADS013	Noida	01 Sep 2026	ananya.gupta@asteriondigital.test
ADS009	Deepa Nair	Head of People & Culture	Human Resources	ADS001	Bengaluru	08 Jan 2018	deepa.nair@asteriondigital.test
ADS010	Karan Malhotra	Chief Operating Officer	Operations	ADS001	Bengaluru	05 Jun 2017	karan.malhotra@asteriondigital.test
ADS011	Meera Iyer	Chief Financial Officer	Finance	ADS001	Bengaluru	12 Feb 2018	meera.iyer@asteriondigital.test
ADS012	Rohan Das	QA Manager	Quality Assurance	ADS002	Pune	11 Mar 2019	rohan.das@asteriondigital.test
ADS013	Ishita Bose	Manager, Data & Analytics	Data & Analytics	ADS002	Hyderabad	24 Aug 2020	ishita.bose@asteriondigital.test
ADS014	Sandeep Joshi	Chief Information Security Officer	Security	ADS002	Bengaluru	07 Oct 2019	sandeep.joshi@asteriondigital.test
ADS015	Anil Kumar	Delivery Manager	Operations	ADS010	Noida	20 May 2019	anil.kumar@asteriondigital.test

Employee ID	Full name	Designation	Department	Reports to	Location	Date of joining	Email
ADS016	Farhan Ali	Cloud & DevOps Manager	Cloud & Infrastructure	ADS002	Hyderabad	17 Feb 2020	farhan.ali@asteriondigital.test
ADS017	Pooja Menon	Payroll Executive	Finance	ADS011	Bengaluru	05 Apr 2021	pooja.menon@asteriondigital.test
ADS018	Suresh Pillai	IT Support Lead	IT Services	ADS010	Bengaluru	15 Nov 2021	suresh.pillai@asteriondigital.test
ADS019	Tanvi Deshpande	Employee Relations Officer	Human Resources	ADS009	Pune	10 Jan 2022	tanvi.deshpande@asteriondigital.test